

ARIZONA EARLY LEARNING STANDARDS

4th Edition

May 2018



SOCIAL EMOTIONAL DEVELOPMENT STANDARD

Social emotional development is the core of early care and education because it sets a firm foundation on which all other learning will take place.

Children's emotional development is built into the architecture of their brains. Relationships that provide social, emotional, and physical security promote and enhance a child's ability to learn and thrive.

To grow socially and emotionally, children need to develop an increasing capacity to experience, express, and gain self-control over their emotions and social interactions. This development is enhanced by nurturing relationships and positive early learning experiences. A consistent, predictable, and engaging environment strengthens a child's confidence in approaching new challenges, interacting with others, and exploring their environment.

Established social-emotional skills have a significant, positive impact on a child's learning, particularly in **cognitive development**. It sets the foundation for life-long success. This Standard articulates the ways in which a child can demonstrate their understanding of themselves and others, form positive social relationships, and relate to the world at large. Well-developed, strong, social emotional skills are critical when a child encounters a stressful life challenge. These hardships may include neglect, trauma, poverty, cultural and language differences, bias, and disabilities.

The Social-Emotional Development Standard is organized into the following Strands and related Concepts:

Strand 1: Self-Awareness and Emotional Skills

- Concept 1: Self-Awareness
- Concept 2: Recognizes and Expresses Feelings
- Concept 3: Self-Regulation

Strand 2: Relationships and Skills

- Concept 1: Attachment
- Concept 2: Social Interactions
- Concept 3: Respect

STRAND 1: SELF-AWARENESS AND EMOTIONAL SKILLS

SOCIAL EMOTIONAL DEVELOPMENT

STRAND 1: SELF-AWARENESS AND EMOTIONAL SKILLS

Concept 1: Self-Awareness

The child demonstrates an awareness of self.

Children develop a sense of personal identity as they begin to recognize the characteristics that make them unique as individuals and to build self-esteem.

Indicators and Examples in the Context of Daily Routines, Activities, and Play

- a. **Demonstrates self-confidence.**
 - Acknowledges her own accomplishments and says, “I can hit the ball.”
 - Explains, “I’m learning how to take care of myself and my friends.”
 - Signs, “I can do it myself.”
- b. **Makes personal preferences known to others.**
 - Chooses carrots over celery during mealtime.
 - Tells friends, “I don’t like that.”
- c. **Demonstrates knowledge of self-identity/autonomy.**
 - Declares, “I’m the big brother,” while looking at a family picture.
 - Tells the teacher, “I’m at school while mommy is at work.”
 - Holds up three fingers and says, “I am this many.”
- d. **Displays an awareness of similarities and differences between self and others.**
 - Says, “My hair is curly and yours is straight.”
 - Points to shirt and then to friend’s shirt, indicating that they are wearing the same color of shirt.
- e. **Demonstrates developmentally appropriate cultural curiosity and responsiveness.**
 - Wonders about a friend’s seaweed snack and asks for a taste.
 - The group widens the story time circle to make room for the child and their wheelchair.
 - A guest speaker (parent) shares a storybook and song in their home language to the class.

SOCIAL EMOTIONAL DEVELOPMENT

STRAND 1: SELF-AWARENESS AND EMOTIONAL SKILLS

Concept 2: Recognizes and Expresses Feelings

The child recognizes and expresses feelings of self and others.

Children develop **emotional literacy** through the ability to identify and acknowledge their feelings and feelings of others through daily interactions.

Indicators and Examples in the Context of Daily Routines, Activities, and Play

- a. **Associates emotions with words, facial expressions, and body language.**
 - Describes the emotions of a character in a book.
 - Signs, “I am mad” when asked how they feel.
- b. **Identifies, describes, and expresses their own feelings.**
 - Covers their eyes and says, “This is scary!” while listening to a story.
 - Says, “I am happy today because it’s my birthday!”
- c. **Identifies and describes feelings of others.**
 - Approaches an adult and says, “That child is sad. They are crying.”
 - Says, “My mommy will be so excited to see my picture!”
- d. **Expresses feelings of satisfaction in independent activities**
 - Independently peddles the tricycle with a smile on their face.
 - Displays their clay structure and says, “Look what I did!”
- e. **Expresses empathy for others.**
 - Sees a friend crying and then gives the friend a hug.
 - Asks, “Are you ok?” after seeing a friend fall down.

SOCIAL EMOTIONAL DEVELOPMENT

STRAND 1: SELF-AWARENESS AND EMOTIONAL SKILLS

Concept 3: Self-Regulation

The child manages the expression of feelings, thoughts, impulses, and behaviors.

Young children develop self-control as they acquire the ability to regulate their impulses with decreasing support from adults. This enables children to function successfully and independently in both personal and social contexts. **Temperament** displays itself through the way a child manages their behaviors in daily activity; temperament is driven by both **nature and nurture**.

Indicators and Examples in the Context of Daily Routines, Activities, and Play

- a. Understands and follows expectations in the learning environment.**
 - Uses walking feet when transitioning to the library.
 - Puts the puzzle away, where it belongs, when finished.
- b. Adjusts behavior and adapts to transitions, daily routines, and unexpected events.**
 - Moves through activities independently.
 - Stays with the group and follows the teacher during a fire drill.
 - Chooses a cozy corner away from the group when needed.
- c. Chooses appropriate words and actions.**
 - Says and/or signs, “Stop, I don’t like it when you hit me.”
 - Waits their turn during a shared game or toy time.

STRAND 2: RELATIONSHIPS AND SOCIAL SKILLS

SOCIAL EMOTIONAL DEVELOPMENT

STRAND 2: RELATIONSHIPS AND SOCIAL SKILLS

Concept 1: Attachment

The child demonstrates the ability to engage in and maintain secure relationships.

Positive social relationships between adults and children develop in an environment where children feel safe and secure. When caregivers provide a secure base of physical and emotional support, children construct secure attachments with their caregivers which supports them in moving into deeper and more complex learning.

Indicators and Examples in the Context of Daily Routines, Activities, and Play

- a. Expresses interest, curiosity, and trust with familiar adults.**
 - Child welcomes a new guest to the classroom.
 - When teacher smiles, child responds with a smile back.
- b. Seeks support from familiar adults.**
 - Asks for comfort/reassurance after a playground fall.
 - Seeks out the caregiver when they need help doing a task.
- c. Separates from familiar adult with minimal distress.**
 - Continues to paint after acknowledging a family member's departure.
 - Transitions quickly into classroom activity after family drop off.

SOCIAL EMOTIONAL DEVELOPMENT

STRAND 2: RELATIONSHIPS AND SOCIAL SKILLS

Concept 2: Social Interactions

The child displays positive social behavior.

A child's relationship with peers and adults reflect their ability to initiate and sustain positive and appropriate interactions while increasing their capacity to acknowledge someone else's perspective.

Indicators and Examples in the Context of Daily Routines, Activities, and Play

- a. Responds when adults or other children initiate interactions.**
 - Selects from the choice board when asked, "What do you want to do now?"
 - Decides whether to join a group when invited to play.
- b. Initiates and sustains positive interactions with adults and other children.**
 - Shares about a new food at dinner.
 - Suggests, "Let's build a road for our cars." Then the children work together to build a road.
- c. Acknowledges someone's perspective by demonstrating positive ways to resolve conflict.**
 - Child asks, "When you're done, can I play with it?"
 - Seeks assistance from a teacher when a disagreement starts to escalate.

SOCIAL EMOTIONAL DEVELOPMENT

STRAND 2: RELATIONSHIPS AND SOCIAL SKILLS

Concept 3: Respect

The child has an increasing capacity to understand social boundaries about behavior and the environment.

When children interact with others, they become aware of the boundaries of acceptable behavior and possess a growing sense of the potential consequences of their actions. Children thrive in environments when they have a sense of ownership.

Indicators and Examples in the Context of Daily Routines, Activities, and Play

- a. Respects the rights and property of others.**
 - Walks around a block structure built by another child.
 - Waits behind friend for their turn to go down the slide.
- b. Defends own rights and the rights of others.**
 - Tells his friend not to knock down his block structure.
 - Tells teacher, “I can’t have anything with peanuts.”
- c. Shows respect for learning materials in the learning environment.**
 - Stacks up books after reading time.
 - Puts caps on markers after using them.

APPROACHES TO LEARNING STANDARD

Approaches to learning refers to behaviors that indicate ways children become engaged in social interactions and learning experiences.

Approaches to learning contribute to their success in school and influence their development and learning in other domains. For example, curiosity is a prerequisite of exploration, and reasoning and problem solving are as necessary for social relationships as they are for mathematics. A child's ability to stay focused, interested, and engaged in activities supports a range of positive outcomes, including cognitive, language, and social and emotional development. Many early learning experts view approaches to learning as one of the most important domains of early childhood development. When children have a positive experience in learning, they are likely to want to learn more.

A child's brain development is the architecture that supports and shapes approaches to learning. Approaches to learning leads to executive functions, an umbrella term for a set of neurologically-based processes that involve managing one's self and one's resources to achieve a goal.³ These include the ability to remember and follow multi-step instructions, avoid distractions, control [abrupt] responses, adjust when rules change, and persist at problem-solving.⁴ When adults provide a solid foundation in approaches to learning, children will be better equipped for kindergarten and to take advantage of Arizona's K-12 Standards.

The Approaches to Learning Standard is organized into the following strands and related Concepts:

Strand 1: Initiative and Curiosity

- Concept 1: Initiative
- Concept 2: Curiosity

Strand 2: Attentiveness and Persistence

- Concept 1: Attentiveness
- Concept 2: Persistence

Strand 3: Confidence and Resilience

- Concept 1: Confidence and Resilience

Strand 4: Creativity

- Concept 1: Creativity

Strand 5: Reasoning and Problem-Solving

- Concept 1: Confidence and Resilience

³ Cooper-Kahn, J. & Dietzel, L. (2008). Late, lost, and unprepared: A parent's guide to helping children with executive functioning. Bethesda, MD: Woodbine House.

⁴ Center on the Developing Child at Harvard University (2011). Building the brain's "air traffic control" system: How early experiences shape the development of executive function: Working Paper No. 11. Retrieved from www.developingchild.harvard.edu.

STRAND 1: INITIATIVE AND CURIOSITY

APPROACHES TO LEARNING

STRAND 1: INITIATIVE AND CURIOSITY

Concept 1: Initiative

The child demonstrates motivation, independence, and responsibility while participating in a range of activities and routines.

Initiative refers to a child's ability to exhibit a spirit of independence, resourcefulness, and motivation regarding making choices when interacting with others or independently.

Indicators and Examples in the Context of Daily Routines, Activities, and Play

a. Seeks interaction with others.

- Joins three other children playing in the sand.
- Asks a friend to play with them on the slide, while playing outside.

b. Demonstrates independence during activities, routines, and play.

- Upon entering the learning environment, the child hangs up their coat and backpack.
- Gathers needed items to paint at the easel (paint, brush, paper, smock).

c. Exhibits flexibility, imagination, and inventiveness when attempting tasks and activities.

- While playing in the block area child shares a picture from a book about buildings.
- Tries diverse ways to make a design using pattern blocks, combining multiple shapes.

APPROACHES TO LEARNING

STRAND 1: INITIATIVE AND CURIOSITY

Concept 2: Curiosity

The child demonstrates eagerness to learn about and discuss a range of topics, ideas, and activities.

Curiosity relates to children's natural tendencies as active learners to explore all aspects of the environment, from objects and people, to ideas and customs. It is through discovering the answers to their own questions that children construct knowledge.

Indicators and Examples in Context of Daily Routine, Activities, and Play

- a. Shows interest in learning new things and trying new experiences.**
 - Says, "Ohhhh, what does that do?" when a microscope is brought into the room for the first time.
 - Gets a magnifying glass to look at a bug.
- b. Expresses interest in people.**
 - Says, "Where is your friend?"
 - Asks, "Do you have a big sister?"
- c. Asks questions to get information.**
 - Asks, "What do birds eat?", when on a walk.
 - Asks, "What color is your dog?", after listening to a story about a dog.

STRAND 2: ATTENTIVENESS AND PERSISTENCE

APPROACHES TO LEARNING

STRAND 2: ATTENTIVENESS AND PERSISTENCE

Concept 1: Attentiveness

The child demonstrates the ability to focus on an activity.

Attentiveness refers to the child's ability to focus attention and concentrate. This enhances academic learning, including language acquisition and problem solving, as well as social skills and cooperation.

Indicators and Examples in the Context of Daily Routines, Activities, and Play

a. Displays ability to pay attention when engaged in an activity.

- Claps every time they hear the /m/ sound in a poem as directed by the teacher.
- Listens for the teacher to call their name and say the color they are wearing before getting up to wash hands, during a transition.

b. Sustains attention when engaged in an age-appropriate activity.

- Focuses on making a menu for the pizza parlor while others are rolling clay to make pizzas.
- Continues to work on a puzzle while other children are playing musical instruments nearby.

c. Ability to return to activities after distractions and interruptions.

- Stops their art activity to join in a problem-solving discussion at the teacher's request and then returns to art activity. Returns to the art project again after outdoor play.
- Continues a construction project over several days, adding new pieces each day.

APPROACHES TO LEARNING

STRAND 2: ATTENTIVENESS AND PERSISTENCE

Concept 2: Persistence

The child demonstrates the ability to maintain and sustain a task.

Children demonstrate **persistence** in their capacity to engage in what they are doing and to meet challenges appropriate to their level of development. The ability to persist in a task is an essential element in learning.

Indicators and Examples in the Context of Daily Routines, Activities, and Play

a. Pursues challenges.

- Continues to stack blocks to duplicate a picture until they no longer tumble down.
- Practices walking on a balance beam.

b. Copes with frustration or disappointment independently or with support.

- Knocks the cup over, sets the cup, and tries again, while trying to pour juice into a cup.
- Seeks out teacher to open bike garage when there are not enough tricycles for everyone.

c. Establishes goals, generates plans, and follows through to completion.

- Works on building a Lego airport throughout the course of the day.
- Works on creating a 3-D art project based on their drawing.

STRAND 3: CONFIDENCE AND RESILIENCE

APPROACHES TO LEARNING

STRAND 3: CONFIDENCE AND RESILIENCE

Concept 1: Confidence and Resilience

The child demonstrates self-assurance, motivation, and stamina in a variety of circumstances.

Confident children feel positive about themselves and their ability to do things or to adapt to changing situations. Confidence is supported by a mindset of resiliency. A confident child is willing to take a reasonable risk, to express or defend ideas, to try new experiences, or to engage in challenging tasks.

Indicators and Examples in the Context of Daily Routines, Activities, and Play

a. Expresses opinions or ideas.

- Indicates carrots are their favorite snack and chooses them even though peers say they don't like them.
- Says to friend, "I can help you get the top to stay on" while building a castle.

b. Views self as competent and skilled.

- Says, "I can pour the juice myself."
- Tells friend, "I don't need help. I can do it!"

c. Is willing to take risks and consider a variety of alternatives.

- Says, "I want to try it", when offered broccoli and hummus.
- Chooses to play with the baby dolls instead of playing at the water table with his friends.

d. Demonstrates a mindset of resilience when approaching challenging tasks.

- Freely finds another play area, when being excluded from dramatic play causes child to be upset.
- Says, "That's okay, I can be snack helper next time", when child is told they can't be snack helper.

STRAND 4: CREATIVITY

APPROACHES TO LEARNING

STRAND 4: CREATIVITY

Concept 1: Creativity

The child demonstrates the ability to express their own unique way of seeing the world.

Creativity involves generating novel ideas while engaging curiosity, risk-taking, and imagination. Creativity can be expressed in many ways. We commonly think of this word in association with the expressive arts. However, creativity involves being able to cope with new situations and problems as well as to see things from a different perspective. A creative child extends and elaborates on ideas and appreciates humor.

Indicators and Examples in the Context of Daily Routines, Activities, and Play

a. Uses imagination to generate innovative ideas.

- Creatively places eight eyeballs and two tentacles on their octopus.
- Suggests, “How about we walk like turtles to the playground!”, during transition.

b. Displays curiosity and acknowledges others’ perspectives.

- Requests their picture to be hung sideways to showcase their personal preference.
- Shows enjoyment of others stringing nonsense words together, such as; “link, pink, stink, frink, gink...”.

c. Engages in inventive social play.

- Says, “Let’s take the babies to the park”, while playing house with a friend.
- Says, “Let’s use these boxes to build a rocket and go to the moon!”, during center time.

STRAND 5: REASONING AND PROBLEM SOLVING

APPROACHES TO LEARNING

STRAND 5: REASONING AND PROBLEM SOLVING

Concept 1: Reasoning

The child demonstrates the ability to think in a logical way.

Reasoning involves the child's ability to use prior knowledge and information to generate a decision or conclusion. Logic and reasoning skills are key to child development in early learning. These skills help children work cooperatively and solve problems independently.

Indicators and Examples in the Context of Daily Routines, Activities, and Play

a. Gathers and analyzes information to reach a conclusion.

- Notices friend is not at the breakfast table, looks around, and states, "My friend isn't here."
- States, "It melted! It must be hot outside", during an experiment with ice.

b. Recognizes relationships between cause and effect.

- Moves a magnet in the sand to pick up metal objects, when working in the science area.
- Reaches for more soap after realizing they do not have enough bubbles, while washing hands.
- Notices banana quickly browned when taken out of its peel, at snack time.

c. Connects prior experiences with new learning.

- Mixed yellow and red to make orange on Monday. On Tuesday states, "I'm going to mix purple and orange to make anew color!"
- Independently buttons own jacket, after practicing on the dressing frames.

APPROACHES TO LEARNING

STRAND 5: REASONING AND PROBLEM-SOLVING

Concept 2: Problem-Solving

The child demonstrates their ability to focus energies on suitable solutions.

Problem solving involves the child's ability to look for or find multiple solutions to a question, task, or problem. This ability is crucial for constructing knowledge as the child builds conflict resolution skills.

Indicators and Examples in the Context of Daily Routines, Activities, and Play

a. Finds out what is wanted or needed.

- Says, "My building is not finished. It needs a ramp for my friend's truck."
- Two children want to play with the red truck and look to see if there is another one on the shelf.

b. Defines the problem.

- Asks, "I'm cold, will you zip up my jacket?", when putting on their jacket.
- Opens the paint container and notifies teacher that the paint has dried out.

c. Brainstorms and chooses a solution to try.

- Gets a wet paper towel and wipes the paint off, when child discovers paint on their pants.
- Asks another child to hold their bike while putting on their helmet.

d. Checks in to see if the solution worked.

- Begins painting after adding water to the dried paint container.
- Sends a marble down the new ramp to see if it lands in the bucket.

LANGUAGE AND LITERACY STANDARD

Environments rich with print, language, storytelling, books, digital tools, and writing materials allow children to experience the joy and power associated with reading and writing, while mastering basic concepts of print.

Children learn language BEST when they are **actively engaged** in meaningful and purposeful interactions. Daily exposure to verbal and written language provides young children with the opportunities to begin acquiring understanding of the concepts of **early literacy** and its functions. Through play and intentional activities, children learn to create meaning from language and communicate with others using verbal and non-verbal language, pictures, **symbols**, and print.

The preschool environment is respectful and supportive of children's cultural heritages and home languages while encouraging English language acquisition. The ability to listen, speak, read, and write emerge interdependently in environments designed to meet each child's unique skills, abilities, interests, and needs.

The Language and Literacy Standard is organized into the following Strands and related Concepts:

Strand 1: Language

- Concept 1: Receptive Language Understanding
- Concept 2: Expressive Language and Communication Skills
- Concept 3: Vocabulary

Strand 2: Emergent Literacy

- Concept 1: Concepts of Print
- Concept 2: Book Handling Skills
- Concept 3: Phonological Awareness
- Concept 4: Alphabet Knowledge
- Concept 5: Comprehension and Text Structure

Strand 3: Emergent Writing

- Concept 1: Writing Processes and Writing Applications

STRAND 1: LANGUAGE

LANGUAGE AND LITERACY

STRAND 1: LANGUAGE

Concept 1: Receptive Language Understanding

The child demonstrates understanding of directions, stories, conversations, and nonverbal cues.

Receptive language is the ability to understand or comprehend language that is heard or read. During the preschool years, children continue to learn language at a rapid pace. Connections within the brain supporting vision and hearing develop first, followed by pathways for early language skills and higher cognitive functions that build on earlier neurological foundations. “Sensory pathways like those for basic vision and hearing are the first to develop, followed by early language skills and higher cognitive functions. Connections proliferate and prune in a prescribed order, with later, more complex brain circuits built upon earlier, simpler circuits.”¹⁰

Associating language with pleasant and stimulating experiences nurtures this development. Young children’s sense of words and sentences, sensitivity to tone, and understanding of ideas communicated, influences their abilities to listen and to comprehend. Listening involves active engagement with adults and peers as they share their ideas, feelings, and needs. Language is learned through engaging conversations, related literacy activities such as oral storytelling and interactive shared reading.

Indicators and Examples in the Context of Daily Routines, Activities, and Play

- a. **Demonstrates understanding of a variety of finger-plays, rhymes, chants and songs, poems, conversations, and stories.**
 - Follows gestures and actions.
 - Teacher asks, “Where would you like to play? It’s time to work.” Child points to blocks or answers, “Blocks.” Teacher extends the interaction and builds on child’s response by saying, “Oh, you want to play in the block area.”
- b. **Engages actively in finger-plays, rhymes, chants and songs, poems, conversations, and stories.**
 - Claps when prompted with, “If you’re happy and you know it, clap your hands.”
 - Participates in story, *Going on a Bear Hunt*.
- c. **Demonstrates understanding and follows directions that involve one step, two steps, or multiple steps.**
 - Places toy truck on shelf when adult says, “Please put the truck on the shelf.”
 - Responds to the directions, “Put the block on the table, put your paper in the cubby, and line up to go outside.”

¹⁰ Center on the Developing Child. (2015). In Brief: The science of early childhood development. Retrieved from <http://developingchild.harvard.edu/>.

LANGUAGE AND LITERACY

STRAND 1: LANGUAGE

Concept 2: Expressive Language and Communication Skills

The child uses verbal and nonverbal communication for a variety of purposes; to share observations, ideas, experiences, problem-solve, reason, predict, seek new information, and make connections.

Children develop language by engaging in conversations with others and listening and responding to rhymes, chants, songs, stories, and poems. This kind of shared interaction is called “serve and return.”¹¹ Children who are encouraged to share their personal experiences, ideas, feelings, and opinions use increasingly complex language. By noticing serves, you’ll learn a lot about a child’s abilities, interests, and needs.

Indicators and examples in the Context of Daily Routines, Activities, and Play

- a. Communicates needs, wants, ideas, and feelings through three to five-word sentences.**
 - Engages intentionally in simple or multi-turn conversations with peers and adults at snack time replying to the question, “What did you have for breakfast?” “My mom made pancakes.” “What kind of pancakes did your mom make?” “She made blueberry pancakes.” “Oh, yum! I love blueberry pancakes too.”
 - Talks with a peer about a trip to a park, another child utilizes sign language which includes social rules; **pragmatics**; age appropriate tone, and volume and responds, “I went to the park too.” “What did you do at the park?” “We had a picnic.”
- b. Speaks clearly and understandably to express ideas, feelings, and needs.**
 - Combines words into simple sentences – “Is it time to go home?” Or “More milk please.”
 - Says, “I want to go play at the water table.”
- c. Makes culturally relevant responses (both verbal and nonverbal) to questions and comments from others.**
 - Exclaims, “I did it!” after teacher asks, “Did you get your jacket on?”
 - Says, “I have a cat, too,” after teacher shows a picture of a cat.
 - Responds, “¡sí, mamá! I have my peanut butter sandwich,” during drop off, after a parent asks, ¡Adiós! ¿Tienes tusándwich?
- d. Initiates, sustains, and expands conversations with peers and adults using open-ended responses.**
 - Approaches peers and asks, “What are you making?”
 - Says, “I went to the zoo.” Teacher expands by asking, “What was your favorite animal?” Child replies, “The lion.” Teacher responds, “The lion is your favorite. Why?” Child answers, “I like the way he roars.”

¹⁰ Center on the Developing Child. (2015). In Brief: The science of early childhood development. Retrieved from <http://developingchild.harvard.edu/>.

Indicators and examples in the Context of Daily Routines, Activities, and Play (Continued)

- e. With modeling and support, child uses language that includes social rules; e.g., pragmatics, appropriate tone, volume, and inflection to express ideas, feelings, and needs.**
 - Responds excitedly, “That’s my favorite!” when an adult begins to read a book.
 - Tells a classmate emphatically, “Stop, I don’t like that!” or whispers in a classmate’s ear during circle time.
- f. Uses culturally relevant responses such as eye contact, turn taking, and intonation while having conversations with adults and peers.**
 - Uses turn-taking during conversations with peers and adults.
 - Looks towards her friend, while speaking.
- g. Recognizes when the listener does not understand and varies the amount of information¹² to clarify the message.**
 - Uses a different word to clarify the intended message when child realizes he has been misunderstood.
 - Points to a picture to clarify his intent.
- h. With modeling and support, uses increasingly complex phrases and sentences.**
 - Says, “Let’s put the cars up higher on the ramp so they will go really fast.”
 - Says, “I want to go home because my grandma is there.”

¹² Flynn, E. f. (2016). Language-Rich Early Childhood Classroom: Simple but Powerful Beginnings. *Reading Teacher*, 70(2), 159-166. doi:10.1002/trtr.1487

LANGUAGE AND LITERACY

STRAND 1: LANGUAGE

Concept 3: Vocabulary

The child understands and uses increasingly complex vocabulary.

The early childhood years are a period of vocabulary expansion and exploration. Research indicates that there is a strong connection between vocabulary development and reading comprehension which correlates to academic success. Children gain language and vocabulary skills by having multiple and frequent opportunities to listen, talk, read, share ideas, relate experiences, and engage in meaningful conversations. They need to play with familiar language and experiment with language in different settings. Rhymes, songs, and read-alouds that use rare words allow children to talk about and develop an understanding of words they would not otherwise hear in everyday conversations.

Indicators and examples in the Context of Daily Routines, Activities, and Play

a. Uses rich vocabulary across many topic areas.

- Says, "Let me listen to your heart with a stethoscope" while in dramatic play.
- Reads *The Very Hungry Caterpillar* and exclaims, "I see a cocoon."
- The child uses new words or signs during play and other activities.

b. Figures out the meanings of unfamiliar words and concepts using the context of conversations, pictures that accompany text, or concrete objects.

- Explains, "I am making skyscraper," while playing with the wooden blocks.
- Says, "I will get the colander to rinse the grapes" while playing in the dramatic play area.

c. Uses category labels and names objects within a category; e.g., fruit, vegetable, animal, transportation.

- Replies, "I want a carrot," when asked, "Which vegetable do you want?"
- Gathers a variety of animals and says, "I found a dog, two pigs, and a duck."

d. Demonstrates understanding of and uses words that indicate position and direction; e.g., in, on, out, under, over, off, besides, behind.

- Responds to the teacher's requests to return his car to the shelf, put blocks in the container, or stand beside a peer.
- Says, "I am standing between Billy and Rita."

STRAND 2: EMERGENT LITERACY

LANGUAGE AND LITERACY

STRAND 2: EMERGENT LITERACY

Concept 1: Concepts of Print

The child knows that print carries messages.

Through daily experiences with materials, in a print rich environment, young children delight in discovering the connections between spoken and written words. They learn what print is used for and that print conveys meaning such as in signs, letters, menus, storybooks, and magazines.

Indicators and examples in the Context of Daily Routines, Activities, and Play

- a. **Identifies signs, symbols, and labels in a variety of environments (environmental print).**
 - Points to a stop sign and says, "That says stop."
 - Sees recycling symbol and says, "This is the recycling bin."
- b. **Demonstrates and understands that print conveys meaning and that each spoken word can be written and read.**
 - Finds name on her placemat at lunch.
 - Pretends to read a letter while playing Post Office.
- c. **Recognizes that letters are grouped to form words.**
 - Asks teacher to write name on paper.
 - Groups letters together and asks, "What does this say?"
- d. **Recognizes own written name and the written names of friends and family.**
 - Reads job chart naming classmates.
 - Picks up a name card and says, "This says Jose."
- e. **Seeks information in printed materials.**
 - Says, "We caught a cricket in our bug jar. Let's find a book about crickets."
 - Looks at grocery advertisements while creating a shopping list.

LANGUAGE AND LITERACY

STRAND 2: EMERGENT LITERACY

Concept 2: Book Handling Skills

The child demonstrates how to handle books appropriately and with care.

It is important to provide young children with many opportunities to interact with and care for books in all environments. Young children need to have access to a variety of fiction and nonfiction books throughout the day, including those that reflect diverse cultures. Through these experiences, children learn to hold books right side up and to turn the pages one at a time to view the illustrations and to gain a sense of the story or content.

Indicators and examples in the Context of Daily Routines, Activities, and Play

- a. Holds a book right side up with the front cover facing the reader and understands left to right and top to bottom directionality.**
 - Turns the pages one page at a time to continue reading.
 - Turns the book right side up before beginning to look at it, when handed a book upside down.
- b. Identifies where in the book to begin reading.**
 - Finds the front of the book, the first page of the text, and the first word on the page.
 - Points to the first page and says, "Start here."
- c. Understands a book has a title, author, and/or illustrator.**
 - Makes a book and says, "My book is called *My Mom*, and I'm the author."
 - Identifies that the illustrator draws the pictures in a book.

LANGUAGE AND LITERACY

STRAND 2: EMERGENT LITERACY

Concept 3: Phonological Awareness

The child develops awareness that language can be broken in words, syllables, and smaller units of sounds (phonemes).

Young children learn to discriminate between the similarities and differences in spoken language. Such awareness is the foundation of young children's abilities to hear and discriminate different sounds in words (phonological awareness). Research indicates how quickly and how easily children learn to read often depends on how much phonological awareness they have.

Children's abilities to play with or manipulate the smallest units of speech (phonemes) are demonstrated in a variety of ways, including using rhymes, alliteration, blending, segmenting, and experimenting with beginning and ending sounds. Phonological awareness and phonemic awareness are the foundations that enable preschool children to later match sounds to their letters (phonics).

Indicators and examples in the Context of Daily Routines, Activities, and Play

- a. **Differentiates between sounds that are the same and different (e.g., environmental sounds, animal sounds, phonemes).**
 - Plays the game, Sound Bingo, and can differentiate between sounds – “That’s a telephone.” “That’s a dog barking.”
 - Says, “Hey, the beginning of my name sounds like that /t/.”
- b. **Identifies rhyming words.**
 - Shows thumbs up when two words rhyme in a poem, cat/hat.
 - Points to pictures of words that rhyme.
- c. **Produces rhyming words.**
 - Sings, “Joy, noy, boy, loy, toy,” while playing.
 - Finishes the rhyme “The fat cat sat on the__.”
- d. **Recognizes spoken words that begin with the same sound.**
 - Exclaims Millie, “My name starts like Mel’s name!”
 - Selects man and mop as beginning with the same sound when presented with pictures of man, hat, and mop.

Indicators and examples in the Context of Daily Routines, Activities, and Play (Continued)

- e. **Hears and shows awareness of separate words within spoken phrases or sentences.**
 - Jumps when hearing a specified word in a story/poem.
 - Claps each word spoken in a sentence “I like blocks.”
- f. **Identifies and discriminates syllables in words.**
 - Claps each syllable of a name during a name game or name song. (Ben-ja-min = clap, clap, clap)
 - Takes a step for each syllable heard in a word. (hi-ber-na-tion = step, step, step, step)
- g. **Combines onset and rime to form a familiar one-syllable word with and without pictorial support.**
 - Selects the correct picture of the cat when the adult says the name by segmenting it into its onset and rime components. (/c/ + /at/)
 - Guesses, “Dog.” when teacher says the onset and rime /d/+og/.

LANGUAGE AND LITERACY

STRAND 2: EMERGENT LITERACY

Concept 4: Alphabet Knowledge

The child demonstrates knowledge of the alphabet. Child identifies letters of the alphabet and produces correct sounds associated with several letters.

Learning the **alphabet** involves more than teaching letter identification. Children must also come to understand the alphabet as a system and learn how the letters function in written language.¹³ Young children begin to recognize some printed alphabet letters, especially those letters found in their own names. To support young learners’ knowledge of letters, adults need to provide children with easy and repeated meaningful interactions with written letters and words within the context of daily experiences and engage them in activities that are fun and interesting.

Indicators and examples in the Context of Daily Routines, Activities, and Play

- a. Discriminates letters from other shapes and symbols.**
 - Reads the book *Chicka Chicka Boom Boom*, and child points to the letter [a] and says, “That’s the letter ‘A’ falling off coconut tree.”
 - Looks at an advertisement (environmental print) and the child points to the “W” for Walmart.
- b. Matches and recognizes similarities and differences in letters, with modeling and support.**
 - Traces the letter S and says, “The letter has curves.”
 - Says, “My name starts with a big A.” The teacher says, “Let’s make a letter A like the letter in your name.” Then using playdough, the child and teacher create the letter A.
- c. Recognizes an increasing number of letters, especially those in own name, familiar objects, family, and friends.**
 - Names some letters while playing with alphabet stamps, magnets, cards, or puzzles.
 - Says, “My name starts with an [I].”
 - Paints the letter L like in her friend’s name, while at the easel.
- d. Demonstrates understanding of letters by producing letter forms using a variety of materials; e.g., playdough, blocks, marker, and paper.**
 - Rolls out the first letter of their name, “K” in playdough.
 - Writes letter “M” for “mom” on an envelope, while at the writing center.
- e. Uses letter-sound knowledge, identifying the sounds of a few letters and producing the correct sounds for an increasing number of letters.**
 - Writes name (Taylor) by making the “t” sound and then prints the letter.
 - Says, “/S/, /s/, /s/, snake.” when looking at a letter [S].
 - Replicates the letter sound when a teacher shows and says a letter.

¹³ Council of Exceptional Children, 20 (2), p. 55.

LANGUAGE AND LITERACY

STRAND 2: EMERGENT LITERACY

Concept 5: Comprehension and Text Structure

The child demonstrates an understanding of narrative structure through storytelling, questioning, and recall.

Children gain understanding about language and reading through their interactions with verbal language, print, and daily routines. Through shared reading (or dialogic reading), children learn about reading concepts by experiencing a learning environment rich in signs, symbols, words, numbers, and art that reflect diverse cultures. When children are read to regularly and encouraged to intentionally interact with printed materials, they develop an interest in books and other printed materials.

“To comprehend what they read, children must continually draw on relevant background knowledge. This means that having a solid conceptual and informational base is a vital part of becoming a skilled reader.”¹⁴

Indicators and examples in the Context of Daily Routines, Activities, and Play

- a. Takes an active role in reading activities.**
 - Picks up a book and pretends to read.
 - Chooses a book and asks someone to read it.
- b. Identifies characters and major events in a story.**
 - Provides details about the characters and actions after listening to a story.
 - Tells adult “The wolf blew the house down.”
- c. Asks and answers a variety of questions about books or stories told or read aloud.**
 - Asks, “Where do whales live?” while reading a story about whales.
 - After reading the book *No, David*, the teacher discusses the story with a small group of children. The teacher asks, “What would you tell David?” The child declares, “I think David should have made a better choice.”

¹⁴ Neuman, S.B., Copple, C., & Bredekamp, S. (2000). Learning to read and write: Developmentally appropriate practices for young children. Washington, D.C.: National Association for the Education of Young Children

- d. Draws connections between story events and personal experiences.**
 - Exclaims, “I have a cat!” after hearing a story about pets.
 - Says, “We went sledding in Flagstaff.” after reading *The Snowy Day*.
- e. Identifies events and details in the story and makes predictions.**
 - Says, “I think the story will be about frogs.” after completing a picture walk of a book.
 - Responds, “I think the bear will go sleep in the cave,” after the teacher asks, “What do you predict will happen next?”
- f. Gives an opinion for liking or disliking a book or story.**
 - Says, “I like that book because David is funny.”
 - Says, “I don’t like that book because it is scary.”
- g. Begins to demonstrate an understanding of the differences between fiction and non-fiction.**
 - Says, “Dogs don’t talk” after listening to a story about a talking dog.
 - Gets a *Ranger Rick* magazine to find information about bears.
- h. Identifies the topic of informational text that has been read aloud.**
 - Says, “I am going to build a house just like we read about in the book.”
 - Says, “This book tells us how to bake a cake.”
- i. Retells or reenacts a story in sequence with pictures or props.**
 - Acts out a familiar story using dramatic play materials.
 - Uses felt board to retell story of *The Hungry Caterpillar*.
- j. Demonstrates reading fluency by use of phrasing, intonation, and expression in shared reading of familiar books, poems, chants, songs, nursery rhymes, or other repetitious or predictable texts.**
 - Repeats phrase in book using appropriate intonation and phrasing “Who’s been sitting in my chair?” said Papa Bear.
 - Says, “Brown Bear, Brown Bear what do you see?” with teacher.

STRAND 3: EMERGENT WRITING

LANGUAGE AND LITERACY

STRAND 3: EMERGENT WRITING

Concept 1: Writing Processes and Writing Applications

Children engage in a variety of writing activities and begin to convey meaning through their increasingly sophisticated marks. Children write to communicate ideas and to convey meaning. These skills include the understanding of print, the development of motor skills, and the generation of ideas.

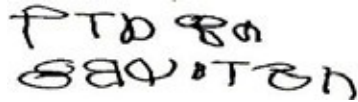
Children begin to recognize the relationship between spoken and written messages by engaging in writing, drawing, and related activities that have meaning and purpose for them. Children receive powerful messages about literacy's pleasures and rewards by observing others' reading and writing. Children develop as writers when they are encouraged to write in an environment that has readily accessible writing materials. Children's writing develops in a well-defined sequence that represents their understanding of how print works. The stages begin with simple scribbles and progress to writing words in a conventional manner.¹⁵

Indicators and examples in the Context of Daily Routines, Activities, and Play

- a. In writing process, uses a variety of writing tools, materials, and surfaces to create drawings or symbols.**
 - Draws random lines/scribbles on a page.
 - Scribbles a note to mom, prior to leaving school.
 - Draws to produce letter-like forms - creating a mock word - the child says, "This is 'Papa'."
 - Listens to a book about where people live, and paints a picture of their home.
 - Uses an interactive whiteboard to make an onscreen drawing of the snake from a story about snakes.
- b. Writes own name using letter-like forms or conventional print.**
 - Writes own name on drawing.
 - Writes own name from left to right on the sidewalk when playing with chalk on sidewalk.

c. Intentionally uses scribbles/writing and inventive writing to convey meaning, ideas, or to tell a story; e.g., signing artwork, captioning, labeling, creating lists, making notes.

- Asks, “What would you like to eat?” while playing restaurant and scribbles the order on a pad.



- Writes W L C M and says, “This says, ‘Welcome’.”

d. Forms letters starting with large motor (sky writing, paint brush and water, sidewalk chalk) progressing to finemotor (paper and writing utensil).

- Writes letters from name on the sidewalk with chalk.
- Writes letter-like forms on a page and says, “This is a note for my mommy.”

e. Organizes writing from left to right, indicating a print awareness that letters cluster as words and words cluster into phrases or sentences by use of spacing or marks.

- Plays at writing a message by placing spaces between the “words” on the page.
- Writes a series of letters and asks, “What word does this make?”

MATHEMATICS STANDARD

Mathematics is a way of thinking, knowing, problem-solving, and reasoning that is accessible to all children regardless of their prior knowledge and experiences.

Mathematical knowledge, interests, and skills are basic to children's success in school and later life. From a very early age, mathematics helps children to connect ideas, develop logical thinking, question, analyze, and understand the world around them.

Through their senses, children embrace mathematics as an integral part of their world. Children thrive in environments that promote thinking and curiosity, are rich in mathematical language, and nurture their natural drive to explore and experiment with numbers, shapes, measurement, and patterns. Spontaneous and planned math experiences that are developmentally appropriate encourage children's positive attitudes towards mathematics.

The Mathematics Standard is organized into the following strands and related Concepts:

Strand 1: Counting and Cardinality

- Concept 1: Counts Out Loud
- Concept 2: Knows Number Names and Symbols
- Concept 3: Compares Numbers and Quantities
- Concept 4: Counts to Tell Number of Objects

Strand 2: Operations and Algebraic Thinking

- Concept 1: Explores Addition and Subtraction
- Concept 2: Patterning

Strand 3: Measurement and Data

- Concept 1: Sorts and Classifies
- Concept 2: Data Analysis
- Concept 3: Measures

Strand 4: Geometry

- Concept 1: Shapes
- Concept 2: Spatial Reasoning

STRAND 1: COUNTING AND CARDINALITY

MATHEMATICS

STRAND 1: COUNTING AND CARDINALITY

Concept 1: Counts Out Loud

The child counts out loud and uses number words in daily conversations.

To build an understanding of counting, children need environments that are rich in mathematical language and provide varied opportunities to count in ways that are personally meaningful, challenging, and fun.

Indicators and Examples in the Context of Daily Routines, Activities, and Play

a. Shows interest in and awareness of counting.

- Participates in counting activities.
- Experiments with and uses numbers and counting in play.

b. Rote counts zero to ten and beyond with increasing accuracy.¹⁸

- Sings counting songs.
- Says or signs to ten while playing hide and seek.
- Counts to twenty while lathering hands with soap during handwashing.

¹⁸ Clements, D.H. (2009). Learning and teaching early math: The learning trajectories approach. New York, NY: Routledge.

MATHEMATICS

STRAND 1: COUNTING AND CARDINALITY

Concept 2: Knows Number Names and Symbols

The child identifies numerals and uses number words in daily activities.

To build an understanding of number names and symbols, materials and opportunities for mathematical thinking should be embedded in a variety of learning experiences to allow children the opportunity to explore and play with numbers and numerals throughout the day, across the curriculum, and at home.¹⁹

Indicators and Examples in the Context of Daily Routines, Activities, and Play

- a. **Uses numerals and number symbols in the context of daily routines, activities, and play.**
 - Draws a squiggly line and says, “Here is my phone number.”
 - Looks at the grocery advertisement and says, “Oranges are on sale for three dollars.”
- b. **Uses and creates symbols to represent numbers.**
 - Holds up four fingers when asked, “How old are you?”
 - Uses buttons and other manipulatives to represent numbers.
- c. **Uses a variety of materials (i.e. clay, sand, shaving cream) to write and form numerals and numeral-like symbols.**
 - Writes out a bill while playing restaurant and says, “You owe ten dollars.”
 - Scrapes lines in the sand table and says, “I wrote the number one.”
- d. **Identifies numerals zero to ten.**
 - Names some numerals while reading a book.
 - Recognizes numerals in the environment; e.g., signs, grocery store, room numbers.
 - Points to numerals on his shirt and says, “I have a two and a five on my shirt.” (The numerals may or may not be a two and a five).
- e. **Differentiates some written numerals from written letters.**
 - Describes the numeral eight as a racetrack.
 - Says, “The four looks like the letter H missing a leg.”

¹⁹ Moomaw, S. & Hieronymus, B. (2011). More than counting: Math activities for preschool and Kindergarten. St. Paul, MN: Red Leaf Press.

MATHEMATICS

STRAND 1: COUNTING AND CARDINALITY

Concept 3: Compares Numbers and Quantities

The child applies a range of strategies such as matching or counting to compare sets of objects.

Children develop an understanding of numbers through hands-on experiences, using a variety of objects found in the home, the learning environment, and nature. To build an understanding of numbers and the quantities they represent, young children need daily experiences involving comparing groups of objects in ways that are personally meaningful, challenging, and fun.

Indicators and Examples in the Context of Daily Routines, Activities, and Play

a. Compares two sets of objects using terms such as greater than, less than, or equal to.

- Looks at friend's blocks and says, "I have more blocks than you."
- Matches one car for each person to see if there are fewer cars or people.

MATHEMATICS

STRAND 1: COUNTING AND CARDINALITY

Concept 4: Counts to Tell Number of Objects

The child uses number words and counting to identify quantity.

Developing an understanding of numbers begins with hands-on experiences using a variety of objects found in the home, the learning environment, and nature. To build an understanding of “how much” and to explore number relationships, children need daily experiences involving counting in ways that are personally meaningful, challenging, and fun¹.

Indicators and Examples in the Context of Daily Routines, Activities, and Play

- a. Identifies quantities of three to five objects without counting using visual approximation (Subitize).**
 - Sees and labels collections of one to three with a number.²⁰
 - Looks at a pile of blocks and says, “There are four blocks.”
- b. Demonstrates the ability to match object to object in a group (One-to-one correspondence).**
 - Matches one cup to each plate at the table during snack time.
 - Recognizes that there is one shoe for each foot.
- c. Counts groups of objects using a number word for each object (Rational counting).**
 - Assigns a number name to cars on the rug, “one, two, three, four, five.”
 - Counts out four straws for the four children at the table.
- d. Counts a collection of up to ten items using the last counting word to tell, “How many?” (Cardinality)**
 - Counts out six eggs. When adult asks, “How many?” the child responds, “six.”
 - Counts and responds, “seven” when the teacher asks, “How many children are here today?”
- e. Matches numerals to quantities using manipulatives.**
 - Spins a spinner, lands on five and moves five steps.
 - Matches three objects to the numeral three.

²⁰ Copley, J.V. (2009). The young child and mathematics, 2nd edition. Washington, D.C.: NAEYC.

STRAND 2: OPERATIONS AND ALGEBRAIC THINKING

MATHEMATICS

STRAND 2: OPERATIONS AND ALGEBRAIC THINKING

Concept 1: Explores Addition and Subtraction

The child recognizes addition as adding to and subtraction as taking away from.

Developing an understanding of a number begins with hands-on experiences using a variety of objects found in the home, the learning environment, and nature. To build an understanding of numbers and to discover number relationships, children need opportunities to describe the changes that result from putting sets of objects together or taking them apart (e.g., blocks, animals, toy people).

Indicators and Examples in the Context of Daily Routines, Activities, and Play

- a. Recognizes that adding increases the number of objects in a group.**
 - Adds one block to the pile of blocks and says, “Now I have more.”
 - Adds another slice of apple on the plate and says, “Now I have two.”
- b. Describes changes in two or more sets of objects when they are combined.**
 - Recognizes that three cars and two trucks is a total of five vehicles.
 - Puts the red, yellow, and blue crayons together and tells how many crayons.
- c. Recognizes that taking away (subtracting) decreases the number of objects in a group**
 - Eats an apple slice and says, “I only have one left.”
 - Gives some marbles to a friend and then says, “Now I have less.”
- d. Describes changes in a set of objects when they are separated into parts.**
 - Plays with a plastic ball and bowling pins and tells how many pins fell down and how many are left standing.
 - Gives two grapes to a friend and says, “Now I have two grapes, and you have two grapes.”
- e. Counts on from the larger number for addition.**
 - Recognizes immediately a **set** of two and then counts on three, four, five as objects are added to the set.

MATHEMATICS

STRAND 2: OPERATIONS AND ALGEBRAIC THINKING

Concept 2: Patterning

The child recognizes, fixes, duplicates, extends, describes, and creates patterns.

Recognition and investigation of **patterns** are important components of a child's development. A child's ability to work with patterns is the precursor to mathematical thinking, especially **algebraic processes**. Children need frequent opportunities to engage in pattern-related activities such as playing with repetitive sounds and movement or noticing patterns in textures and pictures.

Indicators and Examples in the Context of Daily Routines, Activities, and Play

a. Recognizes patterns in the real world.

- Follows and remembers movements in familiar songs and rhymes.
- Notices patterns on clothing. "Look, the stripes on your shirt go red, blue, red, blue."
- Anticipates what comes next in the daily routine.

b. Fixes simple patterns.

- Sees a row of blocks: red, blue, red, red the child says, "Hey something is wrong, that block should be blue."
- Notices that their peers' insect manipulatives are lined up as butterfly, ladybug, butterfly, and cricket and says, "the ladybug comes after the butterfly."

c. Duplicates simple patterns.

- Matches a pattern on a picture to make a necklace from shaped beads.
- Imitates a pattern in a rhythmic activity such as stomp, clap, stomp, and clap.

d. Extends patterns.

- Places the next two dominoes, one up and one down when shown a series of dominoes with one up, one down, one up, one down.
- Extends a rhythmic pattern by answering what comes next: clap, pat, stomp, clap, pat, - ____

e. Creates patterns.

- Builds a road alternating different size and shaped unit blocks.
- Creates a simple pattern using shells.

f. Describes similarities and differences in patterns.

- Says, "We always wash our hands after we come in from outside, but today we got a drink first."
- Says, "My shirt has two red stripes and one blue stripe, your shirt has one green stripe and one red stripe."

STRAND 3: MEASUREMENT AND DATA

MATHEMATICS

STRAND 3: MEASUREMENT AND DATA

Concept 1: Sorts and Classifies

The child sorts and groups objects by a variety of attributes.

Recognizing relationships between objects, people, and events allows young children to make generalizations and predictions beyond information directly available to them. The ability to think logically and to reason (problem solve) extends far beyond mathematical boundaries.

Indicators and Examples in the Context of Daily Routines, Activities, and Play

a. Sorts and classifies objects by one or more attributes (e.g., size, color, shape, texture, use).

- Picks all the books about bugs out of the library.
- Puts objects together that have the same use (e.g., puts all the vehicles in a pile and all the blocks in another pile)
- Sorts rough and smooth objects into two separate piles.

b. Explains how items were sorted into groups.

- Says, "I put all of these together [helicopter, bee, plane, birds] because they all fly."
- Sorts buttons and says, "All these have two holes. These have four holes."
- Uses labels during clean up to determine where objects are placed.

MATHEMATICS

STRAND 3: MEASUREMENT AND DATA

Concept 2: Data Analysis

With prompting and support the child collects, organizes, displays, and describes relevant data.

Children are natural observers and questioners. To build upon this strength, adults should facilitate children's opportunities to ask questions, **sort** and **classify** objects, collect and display information, and talk about what is meaningful to them.

Indicators and Examples in the Context of Daily Routines, Activities, and Play

- a. Asks questions to gather measurable data.**
 - Asks, "What is your favorite color?" Child uses a photo to indicate a favorite color on a class **graph**.
 - Surveys the classroom asking, "Do you like chocolate milk or white milk?"
- b. Displays data to answer simple questions about themselves or the environment.**
 - Makes tally marks representing the number of brothers and sisters they have.
 - Moves to an area of the room to indicate their vote for the next game to play.
- c. Uses descriptive language to compare data in picture graphs or other concrete representations.**
 - Looks at picture graph of selected fruit and says, "A lot of kids like bananas."
 - Identifies which category has more, fewer, or the same number of objects.
- d. Analyzes data from charts and graphs to answer questions.**
 - Counts the number of children who have a pet and do not have a pet to answer the question, "Are there more children in our class who have a pet or who do not have a pet?"
 - Looks at attendance chart to determine if more boys or girls are present.
 - Analyzes the data by answering, "Why do you think more children like the red apple than the green apple?"

MATHEMATICS

STRAND 3: MEASUREMENT AND DATA

Concept 3: Measures

The child uses measurement to describe and compare objects in the environment.

Starting at a very young age, children compare based on observable attributes and characteristics. Immersing children in measurement activities provides them with opportunities to explore, compare, and discuss the use of measurement in their environment.

Indicators and Examples in the Context of Daily Routines, Activities, and Play

- a. **Compares objects and uses terms (e.g. lighter-heavier, hotter-colder, and faster-slower).**
 - Says, “My car is going faster than your car.
 - Exclaims, “I can’t pull the wagon. The blocks are too heavy. Get them out!” Says, “I need a bigger box for these dolls.”
- b. **Uses non-standard units of measurement (e.g., hands, bodies, containers) to estimate measurable attributes.**
 - Measures how many small containers it takes to fill one large container at the water table.
 - Uses outstretched arms to measure a doorway.
 - Cuts a piece of yarn they think will be long enough to go around a pumpkin.
- c. **Uses various standard measuring tools for simple measuring tasks.**
 - Takes measuring tape and pretends to measure objects in a room.
 - Helps measure cups of flour for bread.
 - Helps measure a doorway with a yardstick to see if a wheelchair will fit.
- d. **Orders objects by measurable attributes.**
 - Places purple color samples (as from a paint store) in order from lightest to darkest.
 - Places blocks in order by height.
- e. **Uses appropriate vocabulary to describe time and sequence related to daily routines (e.g. tomorrow, yesterday, next, this morning).**
 - Says, “After snack, we go outside.”
 - Responds appropriately when asked, “What did you do this morning?”
 - Relates a sequence of events from a trip to school.

STRAND 4: GEOMETRY

MATHEMATICS

STRAND 4: GEOMETRY

Concept 1: Shapes

The child recognizes names and describes common shapes and their properties.

Geometry for young children involves observing, playing with, and purposefully investigating shapes that are found in their environment. Beginning in infancy, children compare objects by form and shape. This familiarity is a foundation for more complex learning experiences involving shape, position, and orientation in space.²¹

Indicators and Examples in the Context of Daily Routines, Activities, and Play

- a. **Recognizes basic two-dimensional shapes when presented in different orientations.** ²²
 - When reading a book, points to a door in a picture when requested to point to something that is a rectangle.
 - Exclaims, "My buttons are circles!"
- b. **Uses the names of geometric shapes when describing objects found in the environment.**
 - Says, "I have a pink oval," when playing Shape Bingo.
 - Asks, "May I have another square block?"
 - Declares, "Look, the stop sign is an octagon."
- c. **Creates two-dimensional shapes during play.**
 - Uses arms to form a circle to represent the sun.
 - Uses finger to draw basic shapes in shaving cream or sand.
- d. **Creates three-dimensional (solid) shapes during play.**
 - Uses blocks of various sizes and shapes to create a structure.
 - Uses clay or playdough to create a caterpillar.
- e. **Compares, describes, analyzes, and sorts two- and three- dimensional objects in the environment using formal and informal mathematical language with prompting and support based on their attributes.**
 - Describes shapes in a feely box, such as, "I feel the sides. This one feels like a square. This one is round."
 - Says, "The ball doesn't have any corners but the shoe box does."

²¹ Hawes, Z., LeFevre, J., Xu, C. & Bruce, C.D. (2015). Mental rotation with tangible three-dimensional objects: A new measure sensitive to developmental differences in 4-to 8-year-old children. *Mind, Brain, and Education*, 9 (1). Retrieved from <http://onlinelibrary.wiley.com/doi/10.1111/mbe.12051/abstract>

²² Hawes, Z. et al. (2015). Mental Rotation With Tangible Three-Dimensional Objects: A New Measure Sensitive to Developmental Differences in 4-to-8-Year-Old-Children. *Mind, Brain, and Education*, 10-18.

MATHEMATICS

STRAND 4: GEOMETRY

Concept 2: Spatial Reasoning

The child uses and demonstrates an understanding of positional terms.

Geometry for young children involves observing, playing with, and purposefully investigating shapes that are found in their environment. Children spontaneously make **spatial** comparisons using vocabulary such as: location/**positional terms**, movement, distance, and transformation. This familiarity is a foundation for more complex learning experiences involving shape, position, and orientation in space.

Indicators and Examples in the Context of Daily Routines, Activities, and Play

- a. Uses and responds to spatial language (e.g., between, inside, under, above, behind).**
 - Moves next to Jaime when asked to stand next to a friend.
 - Says to his friend, “Let’s play under the slide.”
- b. Describes the relative position or location of objects in relation to self or to other objects with mathematical precision.**
 - While standing at the sink, the child says to their friend, “Stand behind me, it’s my turn.”
 - Notices a puppy between two children in a magazine picture and says, “The puppy is in the middle.”
 - Notices that when working with a puzzle that they must flip or rotate the piece to make it fit.

SCIENCE STANDARD

Children are capable of complex scientific thinking and approaches to investigating the world, developing new ideas, collaborating with others, solving problems, constructing theories, and exploring with abundant curiosity.²⁴

Science, for young children and their caregivers, is an active and open-ended search to construct new knowledge. Children ask questions and seek answers to understand the world around them and learn by being actively engaged with experiences, real objects and natural, relevant **phenomena**. As children seek answers, they will plan, observe, predict, and form **conclusions**. Children's observations, predictions, explanations, and conclusions should be respected and valued by their caregivers and can lead to meaningful opportunities to develop skills, knowledge, and relationships.

Children's experiences with scientific **inquiry** form the basis for further investigation and thought.

Learning through inquiry requires both the child's curiosity and adult guidance: planning and preparing the environment for scientific exploration, supporting and scaffolding investigation, provoking deeper thought with reflective questions, and engaging in scientific inquiry *with* children.²⁵

The Science Standard is organized into the following Strand and related Concepts:

Strand 1: Scientific Inquiry and Application

- Concept 1: Exploration, Observations, and Hypotheses
- Concept 2: Investigation
- Concept 3: Analysis and Conclusions
- Concept 4: Communication

²⁴ Bucher, E. & Hernandez, M. (2016). Beyond bouncing the ball: Toddlers and teachers investigate physics. *Young Children*, 71(3). Retrieved from <http://www.naeyc.org/yc/article/bouncing-ball-physics>.

²⁵ National Science Teachers Association. (n.d.). Early childhood science education. Retrieved from <http://www.nsta.org/about/positions/earlychildhood.aspx>

STRAND 1: SCIENTIFIC INQUIRY AND APPLICATION

SCIENCE

STRAND 1: SCIENTIFIC INQUIRY AND APPLICATION

Concept 1: Exploration, Observations, and Hypotheses

The child observes, explores, and interacts with materials, others, and the environment.

Curiosity about the natural world leads children to ask questions and make predictions, which are their theories about why, how, where, and what if. Materials and instructional strategies that are **culturally and linguistically responsive** and relevant to the child's context support their exploration, observations, and hypotheses about relationships between objects, people, and events in their world.

Indicators and Examples in the Context of Daily Routines, Activities, and Play

- a. Exhibits curiosity about objects, living things, and other natural events in the environment.**
 - Examines a Palo Verde (*Parkinsonia aculeata*) branch using a magnifying glass.
 - Wonders with another child which recycled materials would best make a home for the toy animals when combined with giant blocks.
- b. Identifies attributes of objects, living things, and natural events in the environment.**
 - Explains that the wooden ball will roll down the ramps and pathways he constructed because it is round and heavy.
 - Moves in the sunlight and realizes that her own shadow moves when she moves.
- c. Describes changes in objects, living things, and natural events in the environment.**
 - Describes that he grows taller as he gets older.
 - Uses communication board to relay, "When I came to school it was cloudy, and now it is sunny."
- d. Begins to describe the similarities, differences and relationships between objects, living things and natural events.**
 - Places a picture of a baby chick with a hen.
 - Says, "Your rock is smooth and mine is rough" while placing all the rough igneous rocks in one basket.
- e. Asks and responds to questions about relationships of objects, living things, and events in the natural environment.**
 - Answers, "It will melt," in response to the question, "What do you think will happen if we put the ice in the sun?"
 - Asks, "What is the nest made of? How did a bird do this without hands?"

SCIENCE

STRAND 1: INQUIRY AND APPLICATION

Concept 2: Investigation

The child researches their own predictions and the ideas of others through active exploration and experimentation.

Children use their skills and a variety of **tools** and materials to gather information while investigating. Active experimentation requires questioning, refining, and **persistence**. Children explore answers to questions and begin to form more complex conclusions. Information gathered in the process deepens a child's knowledge of the world and their environment.

Indicators and Examples in the Context of Daily Routines, Activities, and Play

- a. Uses a variety of tools and materials to investigate.**
 - Uses various tools to examine insects; such as a magnifying lens, tongs, or tweezers.
 - Selects a scale to figure out how many small blocks will weigh as much as one big block.
- b. Makes predictions and researches hypotheses through active investigation.**
 - Predicts that the igneous rocks will sink when placed in a water table.
 - Says, "If I add another block on top, it will fall over!"
- c. Adjusts their approach if results are different than expected and continues testing.**
 - Continues to mix varying combinations of paint to try to make purple.
 - Looks for another metal object when the magnet will not stick to the coins.
- d. Persists with an investigation.**
 - Returns day after day to see if their grasshopper "friend" is hopping around the playground.
 - Plants seeds and continues to water and care for them as they observe the changes in growth.

SCIENCE

STRAND 1: INQUIRY AND APPLICATION

Concept 3: Analysis and Conclusion

The child analyzes data (their observations and background knowledge) and forms conclusions about their investigation.

Children form conclusions about their observations and investigations by collecting, discussing and communicating, and reflecting upon the information gathered. Adults can help children organize their information using tools such as graphs, digital media, manipulatives, and other relevant methods.

Indicators and Examples in the Context of Daily Routines, Activities, and Play

a. Uses a variety of materials to record and organize data.

- Uses journals, drawings, graphs, or **digital tools** to record information about the pine cones collected on a nature walk.
- Creates a collection of materials relevant to building a “robot” including recycled and found items and various adhesives.

b. Identifies cause and effect relationships.

- Says, “It fell because I let go of the string” while using a pulley to hoist a bucket.
- Explains, “When it rains, the playground gets muddy.”

c. Constructs theories to explain their investigations.

- Concludes that round objects roll down the ramp and flat objects slide down the ramp after placing different objects on a ramp.
- Says, “Your plant died because you didn’t water it.”

SCIENCE

STRAND 1: INQUIRY AND APPLICATION

Concept 4: Communication

The child discusses, communicates, and reflects upon the scientific investigation and its findings.

Based on their experiences, children express their deeper understanding of science concepts and their environment through words and other representations such as digital tools, painting, drawing, sculpting, or movement. When caregivers engage children in dialogue with meaningful scientific vocabulary relevant to their experiences, they can promote language, literacy, and cognitive skills which are essential foundations for later success in school and in life.

Indicators and Examples in the Context of Daily Routines, Activities, and Play

a. Displays and interprets data.

- Places all floating materials on one tray and all sinking items on another tray during a sink/float activity.
- Looks at a chart displaying the various objects used to investigate ramps and pathways and interprets that marbles roll faster than other items.

b. Presents their scientific ideas in a variety of ways.

- Designs their own version of a bird nest with clay, twigs, and other art media.
- Sketches a picture with emerging details of a plant after planting seeds and watching them grow.

c. Conducts further investigation based on prior experience and information gained.

- Says, "Next time I want to see what happens if I water the plant every day."
- Chooses to mix shades of red and blue paint to see if a new hue of purple can be developed to represent the flower petals.

SOCIAL STUDIES STANDARD

Social Studies is the study of the complex and intertwined relationships between people, their environment, and their needs. ³⁰

The inclusion of **Social Studies** in early childhood environments is important to nurture children's understanding of themselves and others. Social Studies includes basic skills and competencies that set the foundation for learning about concepts of social science. Social Studies is about interdependence.

At a young age, children begin to develop their social identity and think about their place in the social world. As children grow, they develop an increased awareness of their personal histories and heritage, and a sense of time and place. Through everyday interactions with children and adults, they develop an appreciation for rights and responsibility within a group, and how social rules help people in promoting safety and fairness.

The Social Studies Standard is organized into the following Strands and related Concepts:

Strand 1: Family

- Concept 1: Understands Family

Strand 2: Community

- Concept 1: Understands Community
- Concept 2: Rights, Responsibilities, and Roles within Community
- Concept 3: Environment

Strand 3: History and Events

- Concept 1: Understands Time – Past, Present, and Future

³⁰ Koralek, D., & Mindes, G. (2006). Spotlight on Young Children and Social Studies. National Association for the Education of Young Children.

STRAND 1: FAMILY

SOCIAL STUDIES

STRAND 1: FAMILY

Concept 1: Understands Family

The child demonstrates an understanding of families and the roles and responsibilities of being a family member.

Children are curious about their world. They thrive on learning experiences that are meaningful and that connect to what they have previously learned. A child's family is central to their understanding of themselves and provides a foundational reference for their roles and relationships at school and within the larger community. As their perception grows, children further expand this scope to understand how systems work together.

Indicators and Examples in the Context of Daily Routines, Activities, and Play

- a. Views self in relationship to others in a family.**
 - Signs, "I'm going on vacation with my family."
 - Mentions, "I have a baby brother and a big sister."
- b. Identifies family members (e.g., mother, father, sister, brother, grandparents, and other important people in the child's life).**
 - Draws a picture of caregivers.
 - Points to or names family members in a photograph.
- c. Describes/discusses own cultural or familial traditions.**
 - States, "We do that at my house" during a story about a relevant celebration.
 - Tells another child about a recent family activity (e.g., holiday, birthday, dinner, and wedding).
- d. Identifies similarities and differences in their family composition and the families of others such as blended, foster, and other family structures.**
 - Participates in a small group chart-making activity graphing who lives with them.
 - Says, "I have two sisters and you only have one!"
- e. Develops an awareness of their personal and family history.**
 - Shares information about their adoption.
 - Draws a picture that explains that mom was in the Army, and now she came back home.
- f. Shows knowledge of family members' roles and responsibilities in the home.**
 - Says, "My big brother cleans up the kitchen after we eat."
 - Says, "I take you to school" during dramatic play with other children.

STRAND 2: COMMUNITY

SOCIAL STUDIES

STRAND 2: COMMUNITY

Concept 1: Understands Community

The child recognizes that they are part of a family and larger community with other people and that they can accept and appreciate diverse people and experiences.

Children become aware of and begin to recognize and appreciate the diversity, similarities and differences, between people through their experiences of relevant cultural and traditional events. Diversity can take many forms: gender, ethnicity, age, religion, family structure, ability levels, body shape, culture, language, to name a few. Children gain awareness of people and their backgrounds through participation in their community and learning environments. Children begin to understand that events occur outside their own families and their own environment through conversation with peers and interaction with the cultures of others.

Indicators and Examples in the Context of Daily Routines, Activities, and Play

- a. Recognizes that places where people live are made up of individuals who may be from different cultures, perspectives, and backgrounds and who speak different languages.**
 - Says, “My grand family lives on the reservation.”
 - Signs that her mother speaks three languages: English, Vietnamese, and uses sign language.
- b. Identifies, discusses, and asks questions about similarities and differences in other people in their community.**
 - Charts eye colors with their caregivers in large group meeting time.
 - Asks, “Why does your mom use a walker?”
 - Says to a peer, “Your skin is a different color than mine.”
- c. Describes some characteristics (e.g., clothing, food, jobs) of the people in their community.**
 - Describes the clothes worn by dancers at the celebration.
 - Talks about the uniform of the firefighter they met at their neighborhood fire station.

SOCIAL STUDIES

STRAND 2: COMMUNITY

Concept 2: Rights, Responsibilities, and Roles within Community

The child demonstrates a sense of belonging to the community and contributes to its care.

Children recognize themselves as part of their home and community. Children are given opportunities to experience choices and to make their own decisions to demonstrate their roles as individuals. As children learn to demonstrate respect for ideas and rules, they gain the skills necessary for being contributing members of their family and of a community.

Indicators and Examples in the Context of Daily Routines, Activities, and Play

- a. **Demonstrates responsible behaviors.**
 - Assists with setting the table.
 - Cleans up the play area when finished.
- b. **Recognizes that people rely on others for economics, goods, and services (e.g., farm goods, mail delivery, safety, health care).**
 - Pretends to buy or sell food in “grocery store” dramatic play.
 - Says, “I went to the doctor because I was sick.”
- c. **Seeks opportunities for leadership.**
 - Shows a friend how to fold clothes in dramatic play.
 - Selects a task from the job chart.
- d. **Describes the purpose of rules.**
 - Discusses with peers in ways to work well together in the classroom.
 - Reminds a friend to use kind words.
 - Explains, “We wash our hands before we eat, so we don’t have germs.”
- e. **Recognizes that people have wants and must make choices because resources and materials are limited.**
 - Notices that the red paint is gone and asks the teacher for more.
 - Offers to share the sponge in the water table when there is only one available.
 - Turns off the water when brushing teeth.
- f. **Describes their role at home, at school, and in the community.**
 - Says, “I am the door holder today.”
 - Says, “I helped my grandma count the apples at the grocery store.”

SOCIAL STUDIES

STRAND 2: COMMUNITY

Concept 3: Environment

The child demonstrates awareness of locations within and around their community and of the environment.

As young children explore their community and visit a variety of places, they begin to develop a sense of direction and location. While going for rides on the bus or in a car, or while walking in their neighborhoods, children become aware of signs, symbols, and other landmarks. This helps to develop a stronger relationship with a sense of place which encourages children to take care of and advocate for their environment.

Indicators and Examples in the Context of Daily Routines, Activities, and Play

- a. Describes directionality and/or location within the community.**
 - Says, “We went by the library on our way to the park.”
 - Draws a simple map of their home and recreates it with blocks and recycled materials.
- b. Describes some physical features of the environment in which she lives (e.g., buildings and natural elements like mountains and weather).**
 - Says, “There are a lot of mountains where I live.”
 - Says, “It is hot outside.”
- c. Recognizes that people share the environment with other people, plants, and animals.**
 - Says, “Don’t squish the bug! The playground is its home.”
 - Takes photo of the bird’s nest instead of disturbing it.
- d. Shows an understanding of how to care for the indoor and outdoor environment.**
 - Picks up trash outside and puts paper in the recycling container.
 - Helps to plant flowers.
 - Puts the caps on the markers so the next peer can use them.

STRAND 3: HISTORY AND EVENTS

SOCIAL STUDIES

STRAND 3: HISTORY AND EVENTS

Concept 1: Understands Time – Past, Present, and Future

The child demonstrates an awareness of time and sequence of events in their daily lives.

As young children explore their family and community identity and roles, they begin to differentiate a sense of what is in the past, present, and future. While describing, experiencing, planning, and discussing past events, children become aware of time, what is now and what is later. Moreover, children begin to develop cognitive skills regarding how the past can affect the present and future, and how people live and what they do changes over time.³³

Indicators and Examples in the Context of Daily Routines, Activities, and Play

a. Demonstrates an understanding of time in the context of daily experiences.

- Tells their mom that a friend was sick yesterday and not at school.
- Reminds substitute teacher that they go on the playground after snack in the morning.
- Shows the new child in the class the picture schedule so they know what comes next.
- Describes what happens next in a familiar story.

b. Understands that events happened in the past and how these events relate to one's self, family, and community.

- Describes a family snow trip while reading *The Snowy Day*.
- Says, "We had a piñata at my party, too."

c. Communicates time and sequence vocabulary (e.g., before, after, during, later, first, last, yesterday, tomorrow, today) to describe relevant history and events.

- Exhibits their historical thinking, "Before I go to school, we drop my baby sister off at Nana's."
- Tells their friend, "I am going to play in the science center with you like yesterday!"

³³ Epstein, A. S. (2014). Social studies in preschool? Yes! *Young Children*, 69(1), 78.

PHYSICAL DEVELOPMENT, HEALTH AND SAFETY STANDARD

Children in our care deserve environments that are safe and encourage healthy living.

It is important to recognize that children's physical development and their health and safety have as important a place in the curriculum as other areas of development. Children develop skills necessary for future social and academic success as they explore, combine, and refine their physical movements. Thoughtfully planned movement experiences with **vigorous** outdoor and indoor activities should be part of the daily schedule. Therefore, it is important to model healthy living practices and teach children the importance of safe behavior, good hygiene, a healthy diet, and the need for physical activity and rest.

The Physical Development, Health and Safety Standard is organized into the following Strands and related Concepts:

Strand 1: Physical Development

- Concept 1: Gross Motor Development
- Concept 2: Fine Motor Development

Strand 2: Health

- Concept 1: Personal Health and Hygiene Practices

Strand 3: Safety

- Concept 1: Safety and Injury Prevention

STRAND 1: PHYSICAL DEVELOPMENT

PHYSICAL DEVELOPMENT, HEALTH AND SAFETY

STRAND 1: PHYSICAL DEVELOPMENT

Concept 1: Gross Motor Development

The child moves with maturing, fundamental movement skills.

Children are frequently in motion. This movement develops young children's large muscles as they run, jump, and play in both structured and unstructured settings. Children increase their ability to control their bodies and learn that regular physical activity can enhance their overall physical, social health, mental health, cognitive academic performance, and learning.

Indicators and Examples in the Context of Daily Routines, Activities, and Play

a. Moves with maturing balance skills.

- Performs to the song, *Head, Shoulders, Knees and Toes*.
- Bends, stretches, and twists while playing without losing balance.

b. Moves with maturing locomotor skills (e.g., walks, runs, skips, jumps, gallops, hops, slides, leaps).

- Runs during a game of tag, slowing and accelerating as needed to maneuver around equipment and people.
- Hops four or more times on the same foot. Crouches, then jumps forward for distance using both legs.

c. Moves with maturing coordination (e.g., reach, grasp, throw, catch).

- Catches a ball with hands only.
- Steps forward with foot as they throw. Swings horizontally as they strike a ball off a tee.

d. Demonstrates an understanding of movement concepts including body awareness, spatial awareness, and directional awareness.

- Moves forward, backward, and sideways upon request during a game.
- Changes movement when dancing with scarves to avoid bumping into a peer.
- Places hand on the body part indicated in the song.

PHYSICAL DEVELOPMENT, HEALTH AND SAFETY

STRAND 1: PHYSICAL DEVELOPMENT

Concept 2: Fine Motor Development

The child uses fingers, hands, and wrists to manipulate tools and materials.

Developing **fine motor skills** is an important foundation for other developmental areas such as cognitive development, artistic expression, daily living skills, and handwriting. Children begin to demonstrate an increased amount of strength, **dexterity**, and **stamina** to perform fine motor tasks using a variety of **manipulatives** and tools. When children are engaged in appropriate activities and experiences, they develop the ability to gain fine motor control, which leads to independence.

Indicators and Examples in the Context of Daily Routines, Activities, and Play

- a. **Uses fingers, hands, and wrists to manipulate a variety of tools and materials, (e.g., crayons, markers, chalk, sponges, paintbrushes, scissors, pencils, silverware).**
 - Tears paper into pieces to make a collage.
 - Draws and paints a mural on paper taped to the wall.
- b. **Uses eye-hand coordination to perform simple tasks.**
 - Strings large beads.
 - Hits peg with a wooden hammer.
- c. **Manipulates smaller objects, tools, and instruments that require wrist and squeezing motions.**
 - Twists the cap off a jar.
 - Uses pencil/crayon to make recognizable shapes, lines, and dots.
 - Cuts paper with scissors.
- d. **Uses fine motor skills in daily living.**
 - Buttons, unbuttons, snaps, buckles, laces, or zips jacket.
 - Uses eating utensils at mealtimes.

STRAND 2: HEALTH

PHYSICAL DEVELOPMENT, HEALTH AND SAFETY

STRAND 2: HEALTH

Concept 1: Personal Health and Hygiene Practices

Child demonstrates knowledge of personal health practices and routines and understands the functions of body parts.

Children begin to learn self-help/adaptive skills that will assist them in making appropriate healthy choices. They learn that proper nutrition, physical activity, and rest are necessary for a healthy body.

Indicators and Examples in the Context of Daily Routines, Activities, and Play

- a. Demonstrates hygiene practices and personal care tasks with increasing independence.**
 - Uses a tissue to wipe nose when needed and throws the tissue away.
 - Washes and dries hands after using the toilet.
- b. Demonstrates healthy nutrition practices:**
 - 1. Nutrition knowledge
 - Can sort foods into food groups in dramatic play.
 - Explains how they picked melons off the vines when they were ripe.
 - 2. Nutrition choices
 - Explains why the body needs healthy food: “to make my body grow strong!”
 - Indicates their familial and cultural food practices: “I bake bread with *mi abuela*”.
 - Self-regulates own eating by indicating that they are full after breakfast.
- c. Demonstrates active physical play and rest.**
 - Says as they’re running, “When I run my legs get strong.”
 - Takes a break under the shade and drinks water after running on the playground.
 - Rides around the bicycle trail several times, increasing speed to catch up to a peer.
- d. Demonstrates emerging knowledge of wellness.**
 - Identifies function of body parts; “I can use my ear and the stethoscope to listen to a friend’s heartbeat!”
 - Tells caregiver, “I’m cold! I need my jacket.”
- e. Demonstrates emerging knowledge of oral health.**
 - Mentions, “When I brush my teeth, they get so clean!”
 - Knows (from daily routine) to rinse and spit water, with adult guidance, after meals.

STRAND 3: SAFETY

PHYSICAL DEVELOPMENT, HEALTH AND SAFETY

STRAND 3: SAFETY

Concept 1: Safety and Injury Prevention

Child demonstrates knowledge of personal safety practices and routines.

Safety awareness refers to development of the ability to identify potential risks and use safe practices to protect oneself and others. Children recognize and avoid potentially harmful persons, objects, substances, activities, and environments to keep themselves safe. These principles should be relevant to Arizona and to the community/region in which the child lives.

Indicators and Examples in the Context of Daily Routines, Activities, and Play

- a. Identifies and follows basic safety rules with guidance and support (e.g., sun safety, animal and plant safety, outdoor and indoor safety).**
 - Puts on sun protection, e.g., hat and sunglasses, before going outside in the sun.
 - Keeps a safe distance from moving swings.
 - Says, “When I use a hammer, I wear goggles.”
- b. Identifies basic signs and symbols that indicate danger (e.g., stop sign, poison, exit, flammable, slippery when wet, railroad crossing).**
 - Says, “There is the exit sign” as they exit room during fire drill.
 - Tells a friend “We have to wait; the crossing guard is holding a stop sign.”
- c. Demonstrates transportation and street safety practices.**
 - Waits for an adult to say, “It’s safe” to cross the street.
 - Cooperates using car seat and seat belts in family car or school bus.
- d. Enforces personal boundaries (safety, self-advocacy, and boundary awareness).**
 - Says, “Don’t touch me” and moves away.
 - Tells a friend, “Move, I’m coming down the slide.”

e. Knows personal information.

- Tells a caregiver/teacher their guardians' first and last name.
- Tells a familiar adult their first and last name.

f. Demonstrates emergency safety practices.

- Tells a friend, in dramatic play, to "call 911" because the "doll is hurt."
- Participates in classroom fire drill routine with adult support and modeling.

g. Demonstrates ways to tell a trusted adult if threatened or harmed.

- Gets the attention (by touch or sound) of a trusted adult when made to feel uncomfortable or unsafe by another person.
- Child yells, "Teacher, my friend is bleeding and needs a band aid!"

h. Identifies how adults help to keep us safe.

- Identifies the roles of firefighters and police officers in an emergency.
- Child takes the role of school nurse in dramatic center as takes the temperature of a friend.

FINE ARTS STANDARD

The arts connect all areas of learning and are fundamental to children's development and education.

The arts nurture the imagination and creative spirit of all children. Sensory awareness (sight, sound, touch, smell, taste) is the foundation for all imaginative activity and creative expression. For young children, the importance of the arts is in the **process** of creating and constructing rather than the result of the product.

Arts connect all areas of learning and are fundamental to children's development and education. As children are involved in the arts process they develop independence, self-esteem, and self-expression. They discover ways through which to understand, design, and explain their ideas, thinking, and theories about the world. The arts enable all children to discover more about who they are and gain insight into their own culture and the cultures around them.

The Fine Arts Standard is organized into the following Strands and related Concepts:

Strand 1: Visual Arts

- Concept 1: Improvises and Connects with Visual Arts

Strand 2: Music

- Concept 1: Creates and Connects with Musical Concepts and Expressions

Strand 3: Creative Movement and Dance

- Concept 1: Creates and Connects with Creative Movement and Dance

Strand 4: Dramatic Play

- Concept 1: Creates and Connects with Dramatic Activities

STRAND 1: VISUAL ARTS

FINE ARTS

STRAND 1: VISUAL ARTS

Concept 1: Improvises and Connects with Visual Arts

The child uses a wide variety of materials, media, tools and digital tools, techniques, and processes to explore, create, respond to, and connect with visual arts.

Children approach art as open-ended play³⁴ and communicate their ideas, experiences, and feelings by generating representations using a multitude of media such as crayons, markers, paints, paper, modeling, and construction.

Children develop vocabulary to share their opinions about their artistic creations and experiences. Caregivers can support children to reflect upon and describe the characteristics and qualities of their work and the work of others.

Indicators and Examples in the Context of Daily Routines, Activities, and Play

- a. **Creates their own original works using a variety of materials/media, tools, and techniques (e.g., materials/media, such as, paper, digital drawing application, sand, clay).**
 - Makes a collage using a collection of natural objects like flowers and leaves that were gathered during a nature walk.
 - Chooses to construct a three-dimensional piece using recycled materials and buttons from home.
- b. **Represents creative choices, ideas, experiences, and feelings with details that connect to personal meaning.**
 - Draws a portrait including facial details.
 - Uses oil pastels to illustrate a picture of where they went for vacation.
 - Takes the time to select a piece of paper for the desired texture and color.
- c. **Engages in two- and three-dimensional artistic investigations.**
 - Collaborates with others to paint a large mural of the desert sunset.
 - Selects blocks, scarves, and bottle caps to construct a house in the block space.
- d. **Describes and communicates an understanding of their work and the artwork of others.**
 - Gestures to their oil pastel drawing and signs a story about the picture they drew.
 - Asks, “How did you make the clay do that?” when observing another child’s sculpture.

STRAND 2: MUSIC

FINE ARTS

STRAND 2: MUSIC

Concept 1: Creates and Connects with Musical Concepts and Expressions

The child uses a wide variety of instruments, media, and tools, techniques, and music to explore and connect.

Singing, making, and listening to music are fundamental musical activities of young children. These activities help young children explore and demonstrate self-expression, creativity, and appreciation for the arts. Engagement with music encourages mathematical thinking concepts such as patterning and sequencing, physical movement and spatial awareness, and social interaction.³⁵

Indicators and Examples in the Context of Daily Routines, Activities, and Play

- a. **Experiments with a variety of instruments, vocalizations, sounds.**
 - Uses voice to make animal sounds.
 - Uses a tin pie pan and spoon to drum.
- b. **Sings to familiar rhymes, songs, and chants.**
 - Claps, slowing down or speeding up with the music.
 - Sings the lyrics to the “Hello, Good Morning” song.
- c. **Uses familiar songs, rhymes, or chants to create their own musical improvisations.**
 - Makes up their own verse to a favorite song/tune.
 - Records a rhyming song made up with a friend and plays back for their friends.
- d. **Responds to different styles of music, (e.g., rock, classical, jazz, spirituals, Hawaiian, reggae, Native American, gospel, bluegrass, lullabies, marches, and country music), and music representative of a variety of cultures.**
 - Rocks a baby doll softly when hearing a lullaby.
 - Signs, “I like the music with the drums in it.”
- e. **Describes and communicates an understanding of music in the contexts of daily experiences.**
 - “Bakes a cake” in the dramatic play center and sings “Happy Birthday” to a friend.
 - Explains they love this song because their dad sings it in Spanish in the car.

³⁵ Cooper, J. (2016). Integrating music, drama, and dance helps children explore and learn. *Young Children*, 9(4). Retrieved from <https://www.naeyc.org/resources/pubs/tyc/apr2016/integrating-music-drama-and-dance-helps-children>.

STRAND 3: CREATIVE MOVEMENT AND DANCE

FINE ARTS

STRAND 3: CREATIVE MOVEMENT AND DANCE

Concept 1: Creates and Connects with Creative Movement and Dance

The child uses a wide variety of movement, expressions, media and tools, and techniques, to explore and connect with their own bodies within space.

“As children explore ways they can move their bodies and make objects move,” they construct knowledge about their capabilities as learners³⁶. Movement and dance provides children with a “vehicle and organizing framework to express ideas and feelings as well to develop and enhance locomotor skills”³⁷. These activities help young children explore and demonstrate self-expression, creativity, and appreciation for the arts. Intentional engagement with music between caregivers and children encourages mathematical thinking concepts such as patterning and sequencing, physical movement and spatial awareness, and social interaction.

Indicators and Examples in the Context of Daily Routines, Activities, and Play

- a. **Experiments with a variety of movements.**
 - Stretches as high as they can during yoga to “reach the sun”.
 - Moves to their interpretation of the animals in the story as the teacher reads it aloud.
- b. **Dances and moves to rhymes, songs, and chants.**
 - Choreographs a spontaneous movement to a favorite song in a small group.
 - Teaches a familiar finger play to a friend that they learned at the library story time.
- c. **Responds with movement to various sensory stimuli.**
 - Rolls their wheelchair in response to the beat of the drums in the song.
 - Imitates the trees bending in the wind using scarves on the playground.
 - Use of different tempos of music or sound, light and shadow, dramatic play acting.
- d. **Describes and communicates an understanding of movement and dance in the contexts of daily experiences.**
 - Drives like a train during the transition to the playground, imitating the trains that travel through the nearby railroad.
 - Sways while hearing the “the wipers on the bus, go swish, swish, swish...”

³⁶ Bucher, E. & Hernández, M. (2016). Beyond bouncing the ball: Toddlers and teachers investigate physics. *Young Children*, 71(3).
<http://www.naeyc.org/yc/article/bouncing-ball-physics>.

³⁷ Early Childhood Leadership Committee of Colorado. (2011) Colorado early learning & development guidelines. <https://www.cde.state.co.us/early/eldgs>.

STRAND 4: DRAMATIC PLAY

FINE ARTS

STRAND 4: DRAMATIC PLAY

Concept 1: Creates and Connects with Dramatic Activities

The child uses the portrayal of events, characters, or stories through acting and using props and language to explore, create, and connect.

Children use the richness of their daily activities to create pretend play, assuming different roles and characters. These experiences contribute to children's ability to self-regulate, communicate more effectively, and engage in cooperative activity with peers while practicing roles of others. When caregivers design environments for children to easily access relevant dramatic play tools and props, children can explore and understand the world around them³⁸ creating a deeper comprehension of the relationships between objects, people, and events.

Indicators and Examples in the Context of Daily Routines, Activities, and Play

a. Assumes roles from daily activities using a variety of props.

- Selects from a box of clothes a hat, jacket, and piece of rope and portrays a firefighter putting out a fire.
- Pretends to be a teacher and reads a book to the stuffed bear.

b. Takes on more than one dramatic play role at a time.

- Changes their voice while pretending to be a "daddy" and a "baby."
- Says, "I'll be the doctor and the nurse. You be the patient."

c. Pretends an object exists without using a prop.

- Orders a "cheese pizza" and reaches into pocket for imaginary money to pay.
- Pretends to put on a hat and coat to go outside, during dramatic play.

d. Dramatizes familiar stories.

- Plays the wolf in *The Three Little Pigs*.
- Says, "My grandfather told me a story about where the wind comes from. I'll be the wind."

e. Adds details and expresses original ideas in dramatic play situations.

- Adds their own ending to a story they read in the library center.
- Brings large blocks from the block center to the dramatic play center to construct the wings for the airplane for their "trip to the Grand Canyon".

³⁸ College Board for the National Coalition for Core Arts Standards. (2012). Child Development and Art Educations: A Review of Current Research and Best Practices. Retrieved from <https://nccas.wikispaces.com/file/view/NCCAS+Child+Development+Report.pdf>.